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SUPERSEDING
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November 27, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, FLEXIBLE PRONG

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers loose-leaf binders, with flexible prongs, for use in containing paper.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes: Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-43014 - Boxes, Water Resistant Paperboard, Folding, Set-Up and Metal-Stayed.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp Industry (TAPPI) Publications:

T403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T410 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight of Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T411 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard.
T414 - Internal Tearing Resistance of Paper.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, NY 10017.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The binder shall be fabricated from colored tag board stock with the physical characteristics specified in table I.

TABLE I. Physical characteristics

Basis weight, 24 x 36 inches, 500 sheets, tolerance -5%	Average thickness tolerance -0.001 inch	Average bursting strength, (min.)	Tearing resistance (min.)	
			Machine direction	Cross direction
Pounds	Inch	p.s.i.	Grams	Grams
200	0.014	100	200	325

3.2 Construction. The stock shall be leather-grained or crushed grained on the outside surface. The size shall be such as to accommodate sheets 11" by 8-1/2" (first dimension is binding side). The capacity of the binder shall be not less than 3/8-inch, and shall be equipped with three double-prong metal fasteners with matching eyelets, suitable for use with the binders, permanently affixed to a W-type spine and spaced 4-1/4 inches center-to-center. All corners shall be rounded. A panel, not less than 2-1/8 inches high by 4-1/4 inches wide shall be embossed on the outside of the front cover.

3.3 Colors. The colors of the binders shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order (see 6.1).

3.4 Special marking. Each binder shall be marked with the name or trade-mark of the manufacturer.

3.5 Workmanship. The binders shall be free of cracks, cuts, scratches, breaks, holes, tears, and other defects affecting serviceability. Binders shall not contain uneven sides, tops, bottoms, or other defects affecting appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless

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disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and service conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Examination and testing of paper stock. The supplier is responsible for paper stock testing prior to fabrication of the binders. Each lot of paper used in the fabrication of the binders shall be tested in accordance with 4.1.1.2 to determine compliance with the requirements of section 3. A lot is defined as a shipment received of a single type or grade manufactured by the same source, under essentially the same conditions and used in the production of the quantity of the end item submitted for inspection at one time.

4.1.1.1 Evidence of compliance. In lieu of using his own facilities, the supplier may submit a report of analysis of the paper stock from a laboratory acceptable to the Government, whether an independent test facility or the laboratory of the raw material supplier, as evidence of compliance with the specification requirements. The report of analysis shall include, in addition to the actual test data, the manufacturer's name, name and address of the testing laboratory, date of test, and quantity of material represented by the test report.

4.1.1.2 Testing of paper stock. Paper stock shall be tested for the following characteristics in accordance with the TAPPI test methods indicated. The sample size shall be the sample unit specified in the applicable test method. Failure of any test shall constitute rejection of the paper stock for utilization in fabricating binders under this specification.

Test	Method	Reference
Basis weight	T410	Table I
Thickness (see note)	T411	Table I
Bursting strength	T403	Table I
Tearing resistance	T414	Table I

Note: Thickness determination must be performed on the paper stock before graining. This may be accomplished on a replica sample from the production run.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all binders offered for inspection at one time, as defined in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. A random sample of the binders shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-4. Lot acceptance or rejection shall be based on an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective for major defects, and 4.0 percent defective for minor defects. The sample unit shall be one binder.

4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, and selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Closure defects shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination of end-item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table II.

TABLE II. Classification of defects

Visual examination	Defects	
	Major	Minor
Binders not leather grained or crushed grained on outside surface	X	
Size of binder not suitable for 11" by 8-1/2" size paper	X	
Capacity of binder less than 3/8"	X	
Binder not equipped with 3 double-prong metal fasteners with matching eyelets	X	
Fasteners not permanently affixed to a W-type spine; not spaced 4-1/4 inches center-to-center	X	

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TABLE II. Classification of defects (con.)

Visual examination	Defects	
	Major	Minor
Corners not rounded	X	
Panel less than 2-1/8" high by 4-1/4" wide, and not embossed on the outside of the front cover	X	
Colors not as specified		X
Special marking not as specified		X
Workmanship:		
Binders not free from cracks, cuts, scratches, breaks, holes, tears, and other defects affecting serviceability	X	
Binders contain uneven sides, tops, and bottoms; when closed all edges are not in alignment		X

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of containers.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Twenty-five (25) binders of like description shall be packaged in a close fitting box conforming to MIL-B-43014. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. Twenty-five (25) binders of like description shall be packaged in a close fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed in accordance with the closure requirements of the applicable box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The binders shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice, provided that this insures protection for the binders during shipment and provides for safe delivery at their destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Binders of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in close fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-591, class II; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; PPP-B-636, class weather resistant; or PPP-B-640, class 2. The fiberboard boxes shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification. The wood boxes and wood cleated fiberboard boxes shall be strapped in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Two hundred and fifty (250) binders of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The binders, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in containers that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification rules or the National Motor Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

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5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Color required (see 3.3).
(c) Packaging and packing levels (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Marking requirements desired (see 5.3).

DOD WAIVED COORDINATION

User Interest:

Army - GL

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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